

Absolutely — **explode** is an excellent Tier 1 polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “Within hours, the notifications on my phone were **exploding** so rapidly that I could barely read them.”

Here **explode** is figurative. It means **to increase suddenly and dramatically in number or activity**, not literally to burst with an explosion. But the word also has major literal, emotional, demographic, financial, and technical extensions.

Word family: **explode / explosion / explosive / explosively**

Base verb: explode

Noun: explosion

Adjective: explosive

Adverb: explosively

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **explode = increase suddenly and dramatically — 暴增；激增；突然大量出現**

Your sentence:

> “the notifications on my phone were **exploding** so rapidly...”

Here **exploding** means:

> **the number of notifications was increasing extremely quickly within a short time.**

繁體中文：

通知數量在極短時間內迅速大量增加，幾乎一下子湧進來

Natural translation:

> “the notifications on my phone were exploding so rapidly...”

「我手機上的通知數量正**急速暴增 / 瘋狂湧入**.....」

So here:

> **explode = 數量、活動或關注度突然急劇增加**

1. **explode = burst violently because of pressure/energy — 爆炸；爆破**

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “The gas tank **exploded**.”

「煤氣罐**爆炸了**。」

Practice 2

> “The device exploded without warning.”

「那個裝置毫無預警地**爆炸**了。」

****explode = 因壓力、熱力、化學反應等突然猛烈破裂並釋放能量****

2. **explode = cause something to explode — 使爆炸；引爆**

A transitive use.

Practice 3

> “The bomb was **exploded** remotely.”

「炸彈被遙距**引爆**。」

Practice 4

> “The engineers safely exploded the old structure.”

「工程人員安全地把舊結構**爆破拆除**。」

****explode something = 使某物爆炸 / 以爆破方式摧毀****

This is less common in everyday speech than:

* blow up

* detonate

but it is standard.

3. **explode = suddenly increase in number/amount — 暴增；激增**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 5 — Original

> “The notifications were **exploding**.”

「通知數量正在**暴增**。」

Practice 6

> “Online interest in the video exploded overnight.”

「網上對這段影片的關注一夜之間**暴增**。」

****explode = 數量、程度、需求、活動等在短時間內急劇增加****

Common with:

- * sales
- * population
- * demand
- * traffic
- * popularity
- * interest
- * notifications

4. **explode = suddenly become very popular — 突然爆紅；人氣急升**

A media/cultural extension.

Practice 7

> “The song **exploded** on social media.”

「這首歌在社交媒體上突然**爆紅**。」

Practice 8

> “Her popularity exploded after the interview.”

「訪問之後，她的人氣**急升**。」

****explode = 某人 / 內容的知名度或人氣在短時間內大幅上升****

This overlaps with #3 but is especially useful in media contexts.

5. ****explode = suddenly become very angry — 勃然大怒；爆發怒火****

A major emotional figurative sense.

Practice 9

> “He ****exploded**** when he saw the damage.”

「他看到損壞情況後****勃然大怒****。」

Practice 10

> “She exploded with anger.”

「她突然****怒火爆發****。」

****explode = 情緒突然強烈爆發，尤其是憤怒****

6. ****explode at someone = 對某人大發脾氣****

A common construction.

Practice 11

> “The manager ****exploded at**** the staff.”

「經理突然對員工****大發脾氣****。」

Practice 12

> “He exploded at me over a tiny mistake.”

「他因一個小錯誤就對我****暴怒****。」

****explode at someone = 突然對某人大聲發怒 / 發脾氣****

7. **explode with laughter = 突然爆笑**

A less common but natural emotional extension.

Practice 13

> “The whole class **exploded with laughter**.”

「全班突然**爆笑**起來。」

Practice 14

> “Everyone exploded into laughter.”

「所有人突然**大笑起來**。」

explode with/into laughter = 笑聲突然強烈爆發

8. **explode = rapidly expand in size/population — 急速膨脹；暴增**

A demographic/economic sense.

Practice 15

> “The city’s population **exploded** in the 1990s.”

「這座城市的人口在 1990 年代**急劇增加**。」

Practice 16

> “Demand for online services exploded.”

「對網上服務的需求**暴增**。」

explode = 規模、人口、需求等迅速擴張

This conceptually belongs with sudden increase.

9. **explode = break apart violently — 炸裂；爆開**

A physical extension.

Practice 17

> “The glass bottle ****exploded**** in the heat.”

「玻璃瓶受熱後****爆裂****。」

Practice 18

> “The tyre exploded while the car was moving.”

「汽車行駛時輪胎突然****爆裂****。」

****explode = 物件突然猛烈破裂****

Natural Chinese may be:

* 爆炸

* 爆裂

* 炸開

depending on object.

10. ****explode a myth/theory = 推翻；揭穿****

A major formal figurative sense.

Practice 19

> “The study ****exploded the myth**** that young people do not read.”

「這項研究****推翻****了『年輕人不閱讀』這個迷思。」

Practice 20

> “New evidence exploded the old theory.”

「新證據****推翻****了那套舊理論。」

****explode a myth/theory = 證明某個廣泛相信的說法 / 理論其實錯誤****

Register:

* formal

* journalistic

* academic

This is a genuinely distinct meaning.

11. **explosion = violent burst — 爆炸**

The core noun.

Practice 21

> “The **explosion** damaged several buildings.”

「這次**爆炸**損毀了幾座建築物。」

Practice 22

> “They heard a loud explosion.”

「他們聽到一聲巨大的**爆炸聲**。」

explosion = 突然猛烈釋放能量並產生破裂 / 衝擊的事件

12. **explosion = sudden rapid increase — 暴增；激增**

A figurative noun sense.

Practice 23

> “There has been an **explosion** in online content.”

「網上內容出現了**爆炸式增長**。」

Practice 24

> “The city experienced a population explosion.”

「這座城市經歷了人口**暴增**。」

explosion = 數量、活動、人口等突然大幅增加

13. **explosion = sudden outburst of emotion/activity — 情緒 / 活動爆發**

Practice 25

> “His comment caused an **explosion of anger**.”

「他的說話引起了**怒氣爆發**。」

Practice 26

> “The goal triggered an explosion of excitement.”

「那個入球引發了**一陣強烈興奮**。」

explosion of X = 某種情緒、聲音或活動突然大量爆發

14. **explosive = capable of exploding — 會爆炸的；爆炸性的**

Practice 27

> “The material is highly **explosive**.”

「這種物料具有高度**爆炸性**。」

Practice 28

> “Explosive chemicals must be stored carefully.”

「**易爆化學品**必須小心儲存。」

explosive = 容易爆炸或能引起爆炸的

15. **explosive = sudden, dramatic, powerful — 爆發性的；急劇的**

A common figurative adjective.

Practice 29

> “The company experienced **explosive growth**.”

「公司經歷了**爆發式增長**。」

Practice 30

> “The video achieved explosive popularity.”

「這段影片的人氣出現**爆發式上升**。」

explosive = 發展速度極快、力量強、變化突然而劇烈的

16. **explosive = likely to cause strong conflict — 一觸即發的；極具爭議性的**

A major figurative sense.

Practice 31

> “It is an **explosive political issue**.”

「這是一個**極具爭議、容易引發衝突的議題**。」

Practice 32

> “The meeting became explosive.”

「會議氣氛變得**一觸即發**。」

explosive = 很容易引發激烈爭論、衝突或情緒爆發的

17. **explosive = extremely powerful in sports/movement — 爆發力強的**

A common sports/performance sense.

Practice 33

> “She has **explosive speed**.”

「她有很強的**爆發速度 / 爆發力**。」

Practice 34

> “The athlete trained to improve explosive power.”

「那位運動員訓練以提升**爆發力**。」

****explosive = 能在短時間內突然產生很大力量 / 速度的****

18. ****explosively = suddenly and powerfully — 爆發式地；急劇地****

Practice 35

> “Sales grew ****explosively****.”

「銷售額****爆發式增長****。」

Practice 36

> “The argument developed explosively.”

「爭論****迅速而激烈地****升溫。」

****explosively = 以突然、強烈、急劇的方式****

Important distinction: ****explode vs burst****

****explode****

= violent release of energy/pressure, or figuratively sudden dramatic increase.

****burst****

= suddenly break/open because of pressure; broader and often less explosive.

> balloon burst

> = 氣球爆破

> bomb exploded

> = 炸彈爆炸

A balloon normally ****bursts**** rather than “explodes”, although colloquial overlap exists.

Important distinction: ****explode vs blow up****

****explode****

neutral/formal verb.

blow up

more conversational.

> The bomb exploded.

> = 炸彈爆炸了。

> The bomb blew up.

> = 炸彈爆炸了。

But **blow up** has additional meanings, so they are not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **explode vs detonate**

explode

= undergo an explosion.

detonate

= explode or cause an explosive device to explode, more technical.

> bomb exploded

> = 炸彈爆炸

> bomb was detonated

> = 炸彈被引爆

Important distinction: **explode vs increase**

increase

neutral:

= become greater.

explode

= increase extremely quickly and dramatically.

> views increased

> = 瀏覽量增加

> views exploded

> = 瀏覽量暴增

In your passage, **explode** deliberately conveys intensity and speed.

Important distinction: **explode** vs **soar**

You already have **soar** mapped.

soar

= rise rapidly to a high level.

explode

= suddenly multiply/increase with a burst-like feeling.

> prices soared

> = 價格飆升

> demand exploded

> = 需求暴增

There is overlap, but **explode** often feels even more sudden and chaotic.

Important distinction: **explode** vs **go viral**

go viral

= online content spreads very rapidly.

explode

= broader sudden dramatic increase.

> video went viral

> = 影片爆紅

> notifications exploded

> = 通知數量暴增

This distinction is directly relevant to your passage.

Important distinction: **explode vs erupt**

erupt

literally:

= volcano breaks out

figuratively:

= conflict, violence, laughter suddenly begins.

explode

= burst violently, or increase/react suddenly.

> volcano erupted

> = 火山爆發

> bomb exploded

> = 炸彈爆炸

> argument erupted

> = 爭吵突然爆發

> anger exploded

> = 怒火爆發

Collocation matters.

Important distinction: **explode — physical vs emotional**

Physical:

> “The tank exploded.”

= 儲氣罐爆炸。

Emotional:

> “He exploded with anger.”

= 他突然怒火爆發。

The emotional use metaphorically treats emotion like pressure building up and bursting.

Important distinction: **explode — literal vs numerical**

Literal:

> “The bomb exploded.”

= 炸彈爆炸。

Numerical:

> “Sales exploded.”

= 銷售額暴增。

The numerical sense keeps the idea of:

> sudden + dramatic + forceful change

without physical destruction.

Important distinction: **explosive — dangerous vs rapid growth**

Dangerous:

> explosive material

> = 易爆物料

Figurative:

> explosive growth

> = 爆發式增長

Same adjective, radically different domain.

Important distinction: ****explode a myth****

This does ****not**** mean physically blow up a myth.

It means:

> ****use evidence to destroy belief in a false idea****

Natural Chinese:

* 推翻迷思

* 揭穿錯誤說法

Excellent advanced MCQ sense.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

****explode — literal**** = 爆炸 / 爆裂
****explode something**** = 引爆 / 爆破
****explode — quantity**** = 暴增 / 激增
****explode — popularity**** = 突然爆紅 / 人氣急升
****explode — anger**** = 勃然大怒 / 怒火爆發
****explode at someone**** = 對某人大發脾氣
****explode with/into laughter**** = 突然爆笑
****explode — population/demand**** = 急速膨脹 / 暴增
****explode a myth/theory**** = 推翻 / 揭穿
****explosion — literal**** = 爆炸
****explosion — increase**** = 爆炸式增長
****explosion of emotion/activity**** = 情緒 / 活動突然爆發
****explosive — literal**** = 易爆 / 爆炸性的
****explosive growth**** = 爆發式增長
****explosive issue/situation**** = 一觸即發 / 極易引發衝突的
****explosive power**** = 爆發力
****explosively**** = 爆發式 / 急劇地

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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explode — literal	因壓力、熱力或化學反應突然猛烈破裂並釋放能量

explode something	使某物爆炸 / 以爆破方式摧毀	
explode — quantity	數量、程度、需求或活動在短時間內急劇增加	
explode — popularity	知名度 / 人氣在極短時間內大幅上升	
explode — emotion	憤怒等強烈情緒突然爆發	
explode at someone	突然對某人大發脾氣	
explode a myth/theory	用證據推翻某個廣泛相信但錯誤的說法 / 理論	
explosion — literal	突然猛烈釋放能量造成的爆炸事件	
explosion — figurative	數量、人口、活動等突然大幅增長	
explosive — physical	容易爆炸或能引起爆炸的	
explosive — figurative growth	發展速度極快、變化突然劇烈的	
explosive — conflict	很容易引發激烈爭論、衝突或情緒爆發的	
explosive — sports	能在極短時間內產生大量力量 / 速度的	

For your original sentence

> “Within hours, the notifications on my phone were **exploding** so rapidly that I could barely read them.”

The exact meaning is:

exploding = 手機通知的數量在短時間內瘋狂暴增，一則接一則快速湧入；不是手機真的爆炸。

Natural translation:

> ****** 「短短幾個小時內，我手機上的通知就急速暴增，快得我幾乎來不及看。」 ******

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **a bomb explodes** → 炸彈爆炸
- > **notifications explode** → 通知數量暴增
- > **popularity explodes** → 人氣急升
- > **explode with anger** → 怒火爆發
- > **explode at someone** → 對某人大發脾氣
- > **explode a myth** → 推翻 / 揭穿迷思
- > **population explosion** → 人口暴增
- > **explosive growth** → 爆發式增長
- > **explosive material** → 易爆物料
- > **explosive power** → 爆發力